



Hai, reaperfriend!

If you like this and would like to show your support, you can do so by [buying me a coffee](#) ❤️

Your donations help me to keep the Reapertips website running and allow me to spend more time creating free resources like this.

(If you donated to get this, I am very very thankful aaa!!)

Instructions

By the way, if you wish to skip all these steps, I included a folder with REAPER 6 themes with all the different sets of icons so you can just load that.

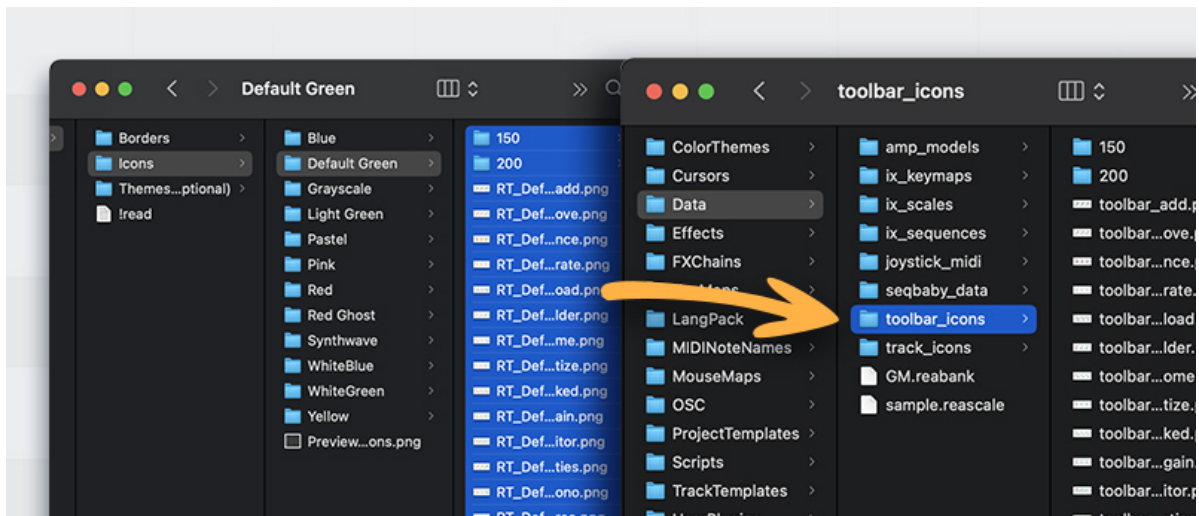
But if you want more **flexibility**, I recommend keep reading 💪

The benefits of setting it up manually are that you can load multiple icon sets and pick your own border style. You can also use any other theme and still keep your icons!

How to import toolbar icons in REAPER

Once you download the toolbar icons and you choose your favorite folder, here's what you do:

1. In REAPER, go to **Options > Show REAPER resource path in explorer/finder...**
2. In your REAPER Folder, go to **Data > Toolbar Icons**. This is where you will drop the contents of your favorite folder of toolbar icons.

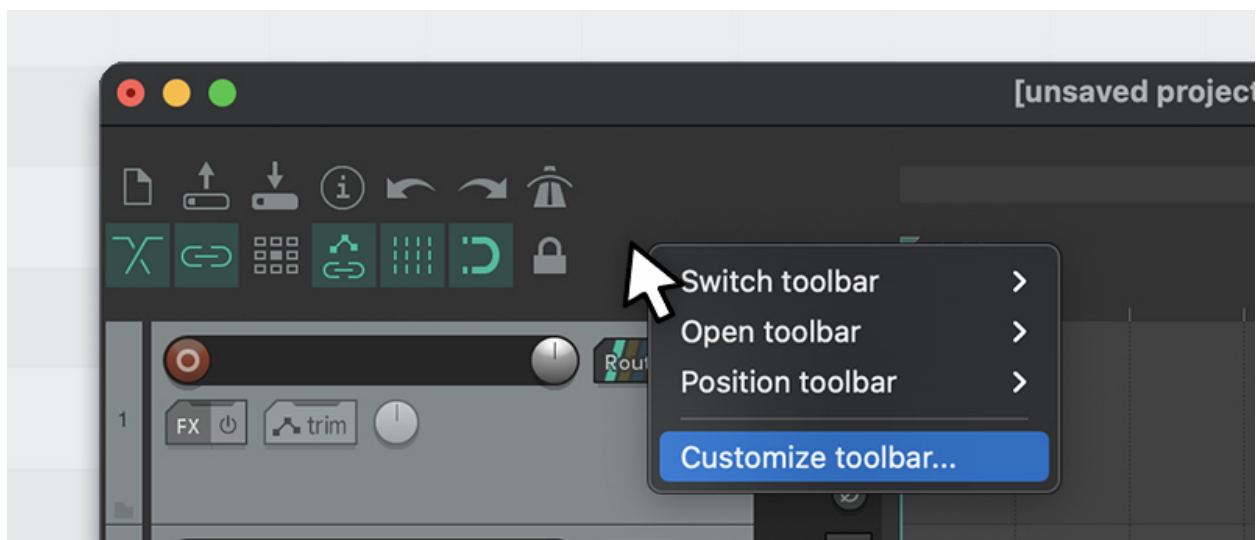


(If prompted to whether replace or merge, choose **merge**)

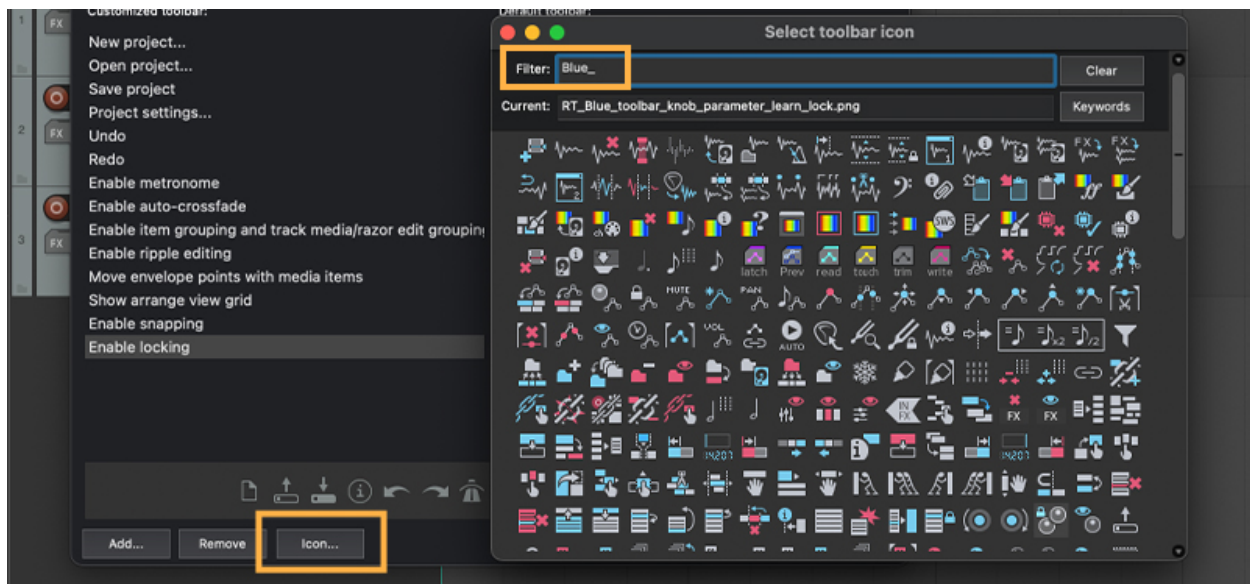
Once the icons are imported, you can close and open REAPER and all toolbar icons should be ready to be used.

Setting up your custom icons

To change the icons in your toolbars, right click on an empty field of the toolbar and click on “**Customize toolbar**”.



In here you can choose the action and click on “**Icon... > Change Icon**” at the bottom left of the window. All of your new icons should appear here, and you can use the filter to search for specific ones.



TIP: To only see the colored icons is to type the name of your theme into the filter. For example if I wanted to search for grid icon in blue, i'd type: "*blue grid*".

You will notice that your icons still don't have a border, though. I will show you how to set this up next!

How to add toolbar borders to any REAPER 6 theme

In the file you downloaded, there's a folder called "Borders". In there you can pick which style of borders you like. I added pictures so you can see what they look like. I really like the "**Rubber-Dark**" border, I think it looks great when it's on and off.

Once you have chosen the style you like, we need to move the contents of the folder to the theme we want to customize.

You will see 3 images named "toolbar_blank.png". If we import these files into a REAPER 6 theme, we can use the image as the background for all our toolbar icons.

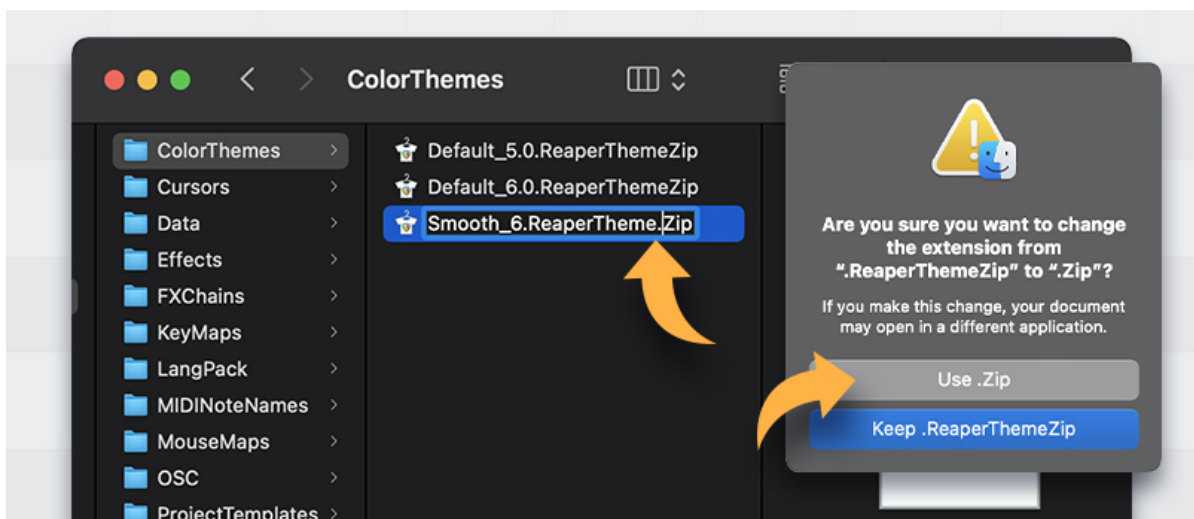
For this example, I'm going to choose "Rubber-dark" as my favorite border and I'm going to use it in the "Smooth 6" theme.

And for that, we need to **unpack** the theme, **import** these *toolbar_blank.png* files, and **repack** the theme. I will walk you through how to do that now. No worries it's pretty

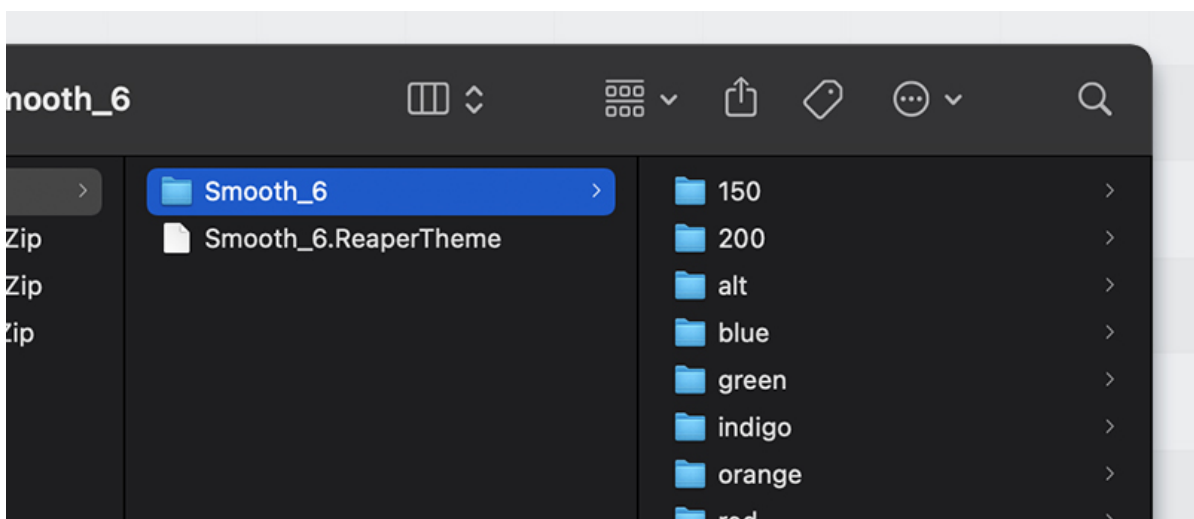
simple ✨

Unzipping the theme

1. In REAPER, go to Options > Show REAPER Resource Path.
2. Go to “**ColorThemes**” folder and find the theme you wanna tweak.
In this case we will tweak the default theme: **Smooth 6.ReaperThemeZip**.
3. To unpack this theme, rename the file’s extension and place a dot before the zip like this: “**.ReaperTheme.Zip**” and unzip it.



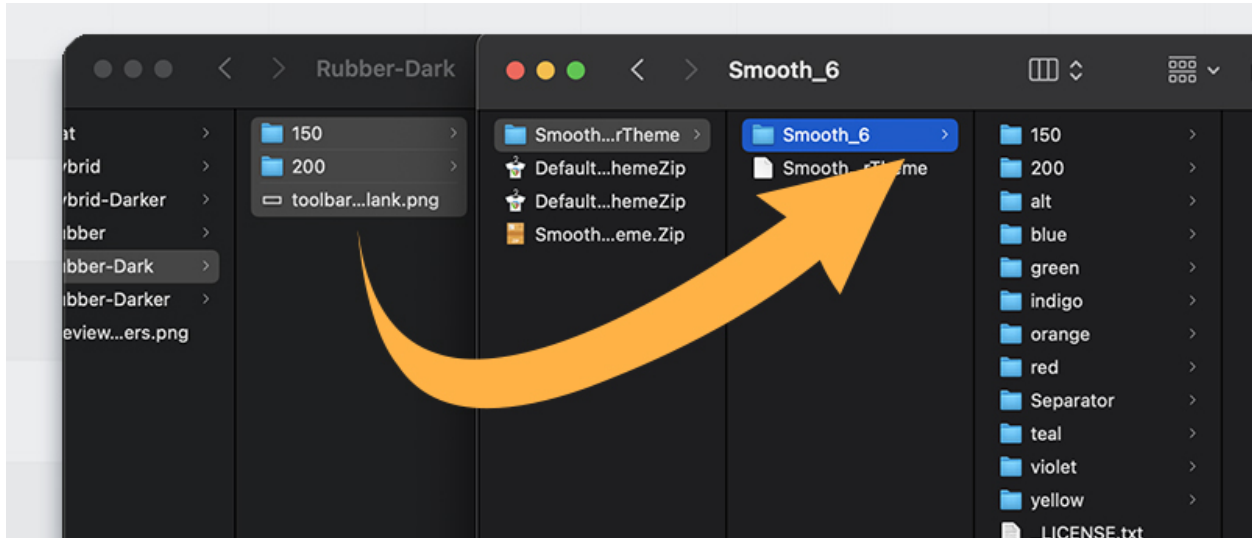
4. **Uncompress** it, and you should end up with two files that look like this:



Importing the toolbar_blank files

Now that the theme is unpacked, we are ready to import the *toolbar_blank.png* files!

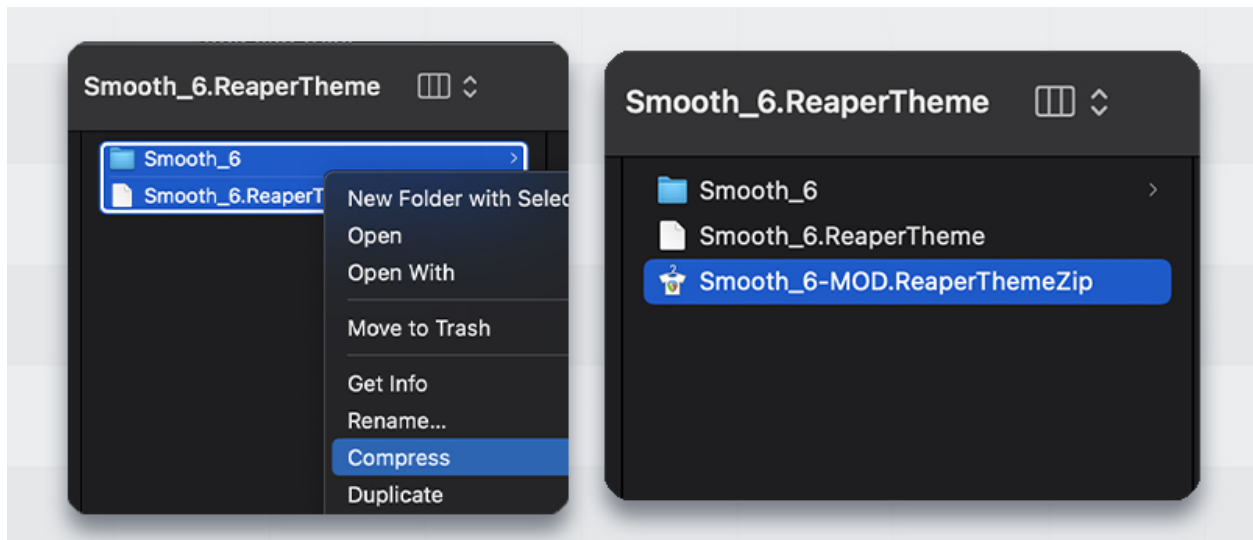
To do so, copy the contents of your favorite borders folder and paste it into the unpacked folder from the theme.



Make sure to match the destination folders. What's inside the folder called "200" goes into the "200" folder in the unpacked theme and so on.

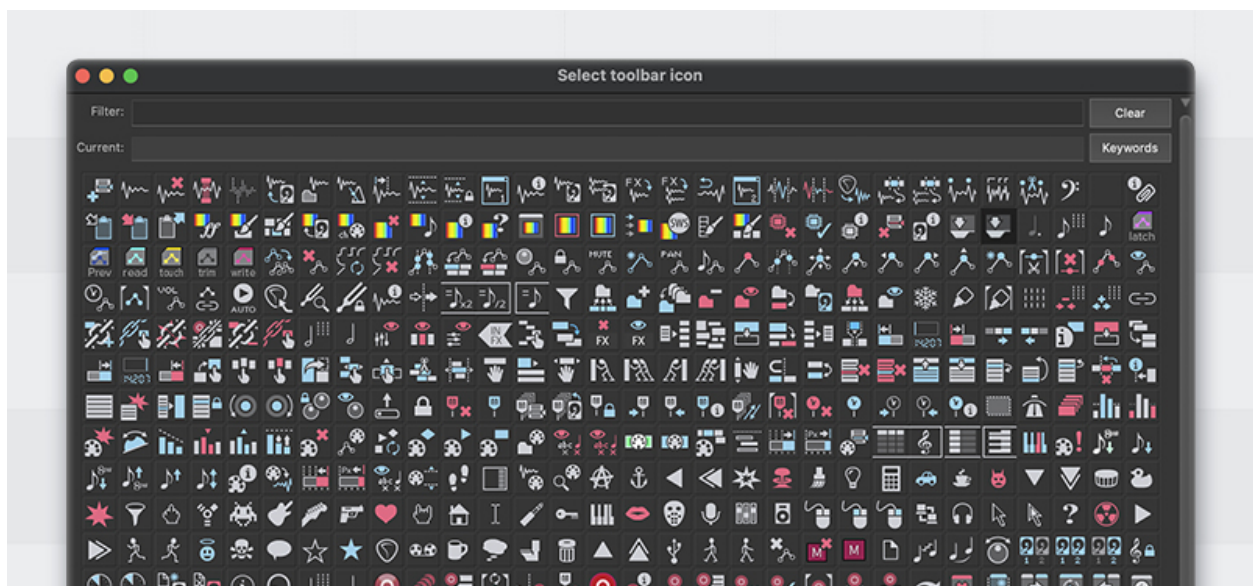
Repacking the theme

Lastly, we will zip back the two files we just unzipped. And name it with the extension *".ReaperThemeZip"*



This is now your new modified theme! 🤪

Load this theme and all your custom toolbar icons should have borders now 💙



Questions

What if I change my mind and want to try another border style?

You'd have to repeat the same steps as before where you unpack the theme, load and replace the blank toolbar files and pack it again.

How do I use the inverted variations?

Simple! Find the “WhiteBlack” icon set inside the “Inverted variations” folder and import it into REAPER > Data > ToolbarIcons. Then, set the icons in REAPER like normal (see the question below for a method for batch changing all icon colors).

As for the borders, choose a border style inside the “Inverted variations” folder. I added a preview image of how each of them look.

For example, if you like “Rubber Inverted” in blue, go to the folder Rubber Inverted > Blue. Then, import the toolbar blank files into the theme following the same steps as above.

What if I want to try another icon color set after I manually setup all icons in one color?

This one is tricky because I'd suggest manually replacing all icons again, which would be annoying. However, here's one trick I came up with that you can do.

Let's say we imported the **blue icons**. But we now want to use the **red icons**.

1. Just like normal, import all red icons into REAPER > Data > ToolbarIcons folder.
2. In the same REAPER folder, find a file called “reaper-menu.ini”. Open this with a text editor.
3. Open the “**Find and replace...**” dialog and in find you'd put the name of the icons you want to replace and replace it with the icons you want to replace with.
In this example, search for “**_Blue_**” and replace it with “**_Red_**”. Hit apply to all.
4. Now, next time you open REAPER all your blue icons will turn into the red icons!

That's it!

This was super fun to make! I think toolbar icons can add SO much to themes. It's such a great improvement to REAPER 6 themes like Smooth 6.

If you have any questions about any of the steps here, I am happy to assist. You can DM me on [instagram](#), or [discord](#).

If you have a color theme request, please let me know, I can make a part two with more color themes like this! 😊

